PURDUE UNIVERSITY | Libraries and School of Information Studies

INSTITUTE of Museum and Library SERVICES

TACTIC IN LIB INTRODUCTORY WORKSHOP

Large language models for librarians

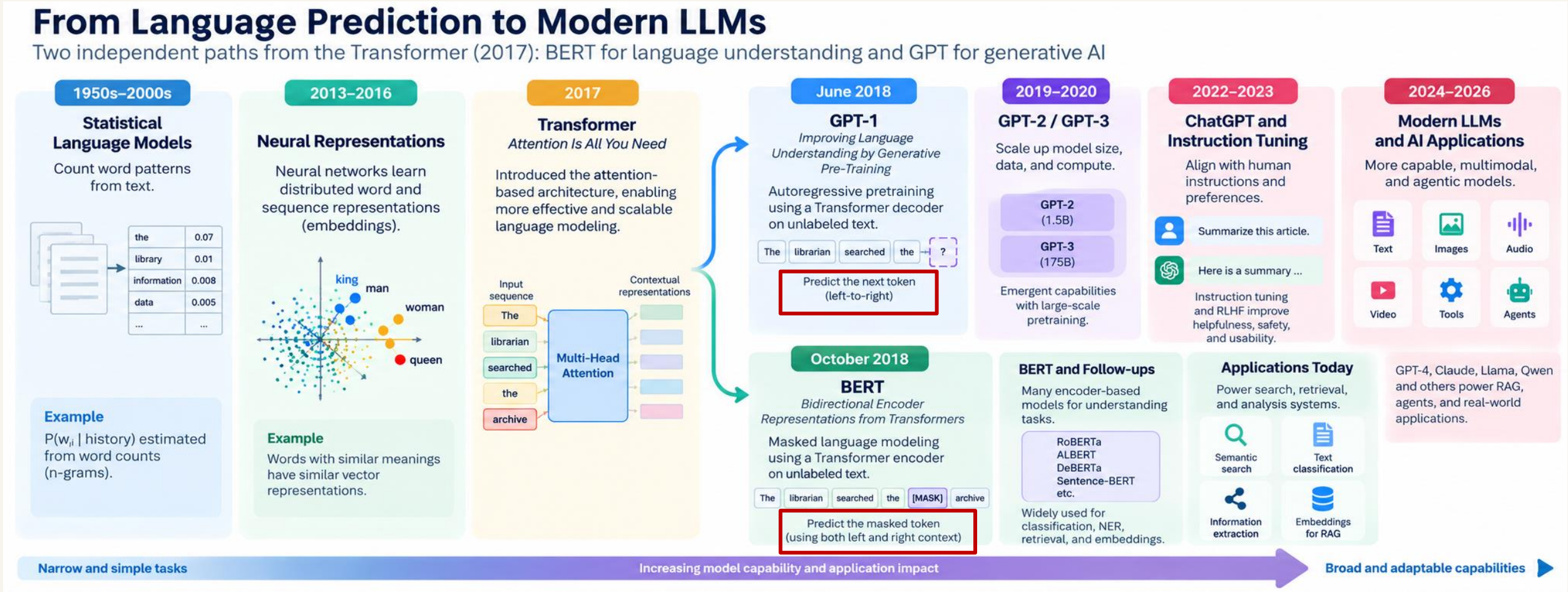
A practical map of the models, the surrounding systems, and the choices libraries control

A model predicts language.
A useful service also needs context, tools, and judgment.

TACTIC in Lib

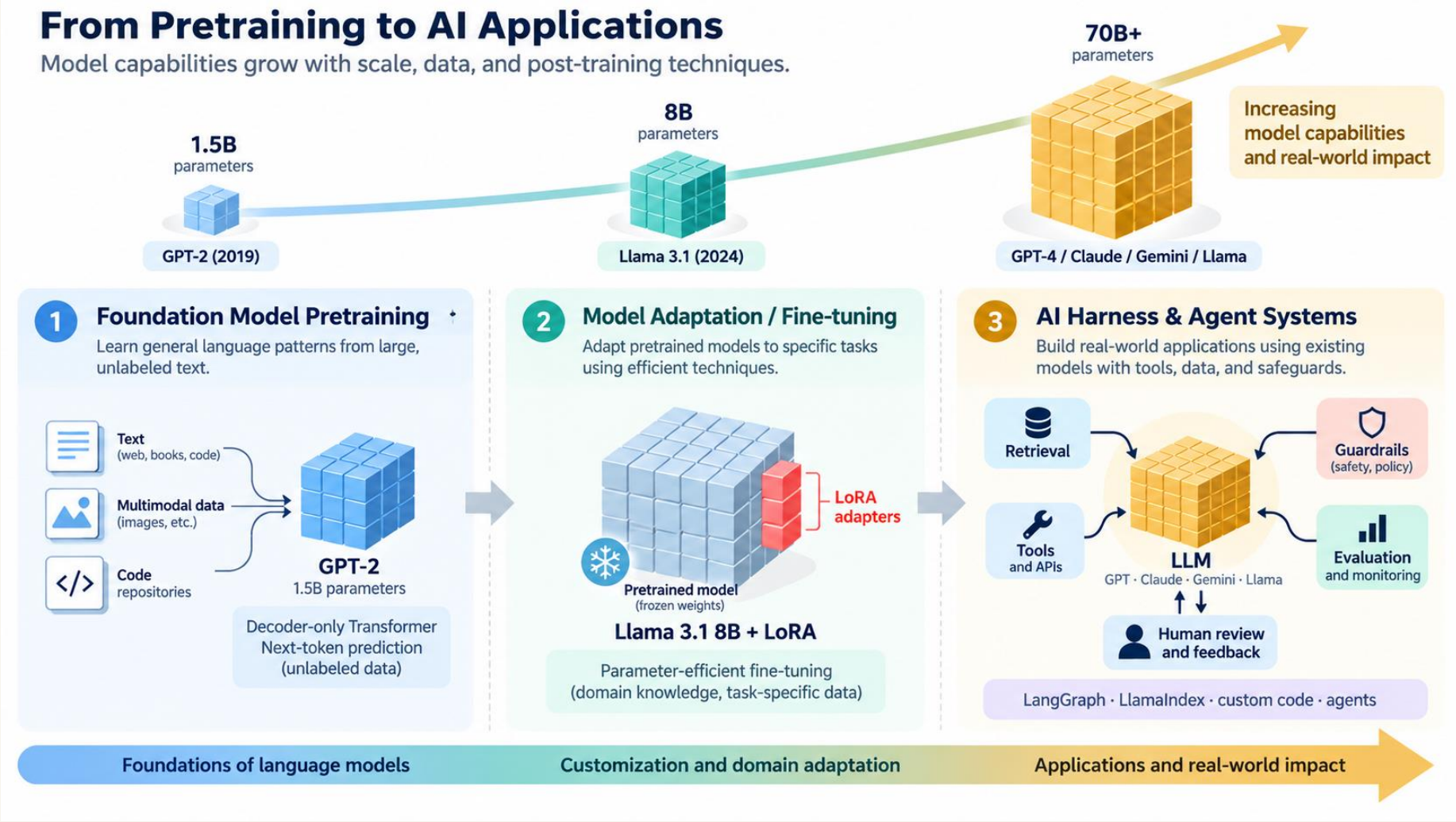
TACTIC in Lib : Transforming AI Consumers to Innovative AI Creators in Libraries, an IMLS-funded AI funded AI training project (RE-258994-OLS-25)

A short history of language modeling



Sources in speaker notes: Vaswani et al. (2017); Devlin et al. (2019); Brown et al. (2020).

History of AI Customizations



More organizations can customize behavior without training a foundation model.

The design focus shifts toward evidence, workflow, permissions, evaluation, and user experience.

Source in speaker notes: Lewis et al. (2020) for retrieval-augmented generation.

Prompts (AI building foundations)

Prompt Engineering

Clear instructions help the model produce a useful response.

TASK + **CONTEXT** + **OUTPUT**

Be specific



"Summarize this for first-year students."

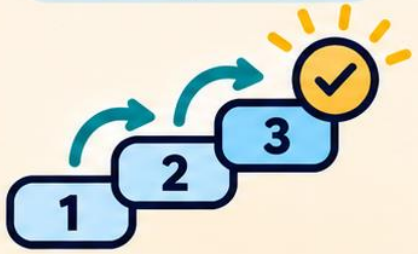
Give context



"Use only these library sources."

Break it into steps

Chain-of-thought / decomposition



"Search, compare, then summarize."

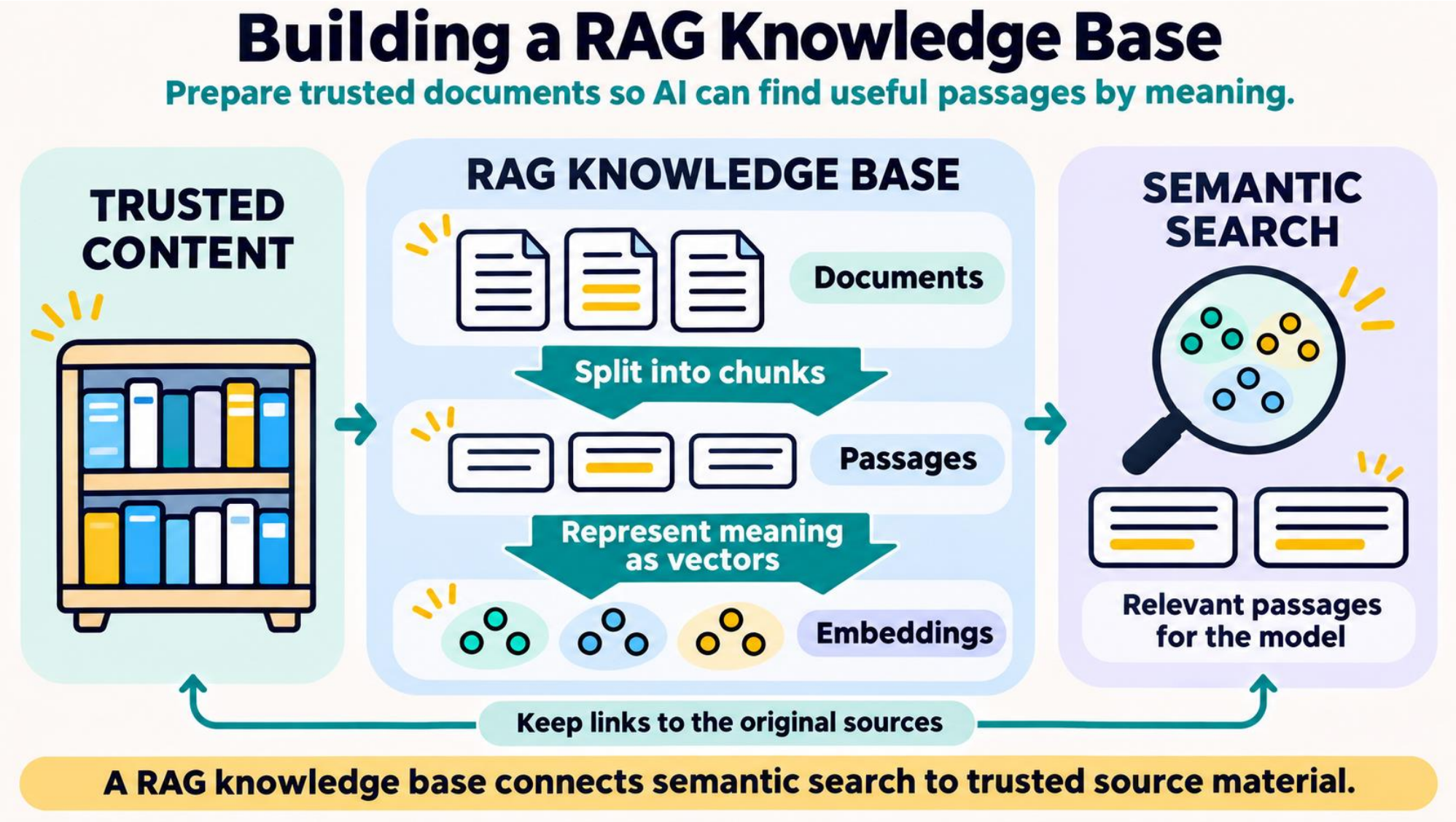
Define the output



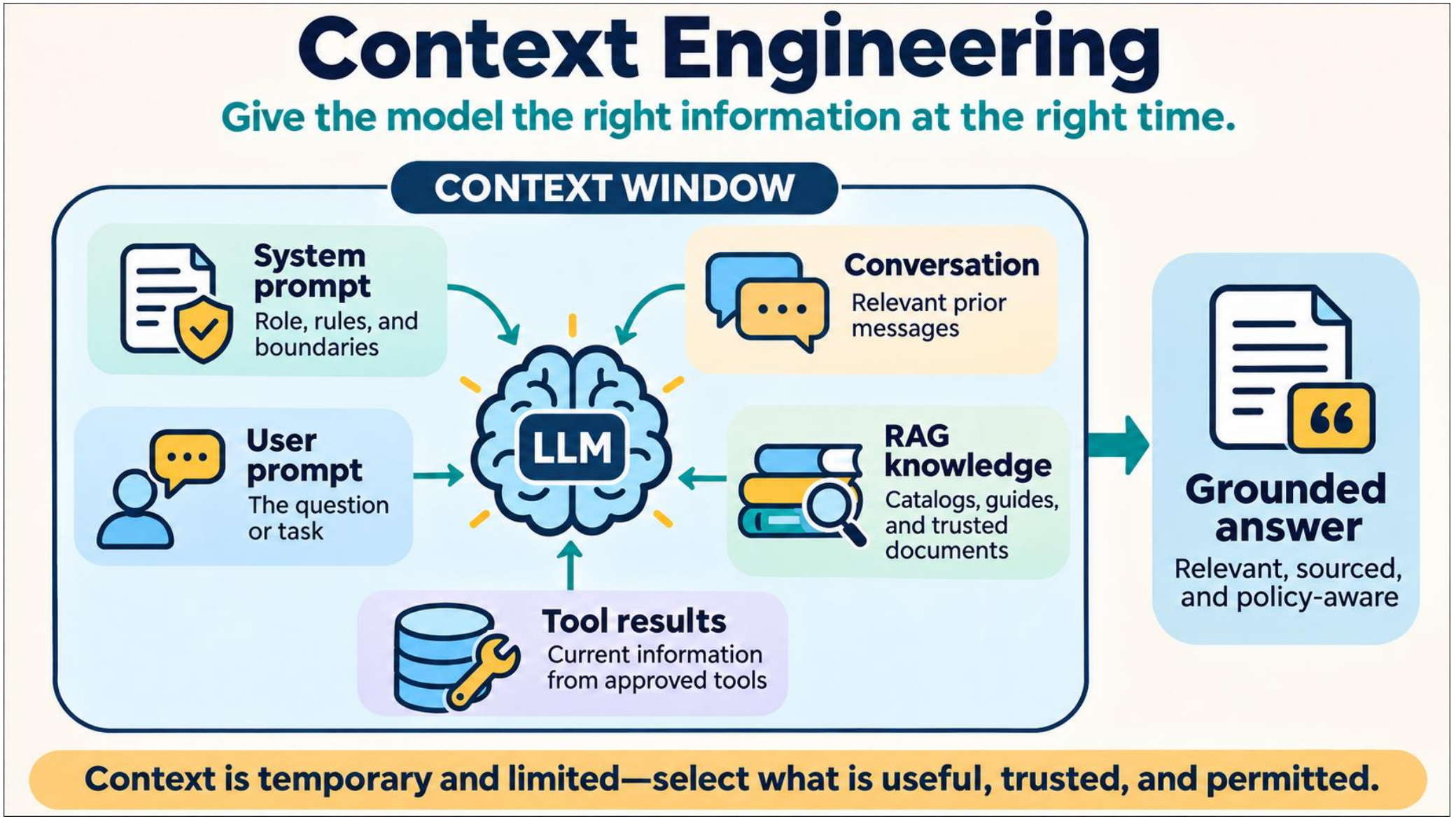
"Return a table with citations."

Prompts guide the model—but sources and human review still matter.

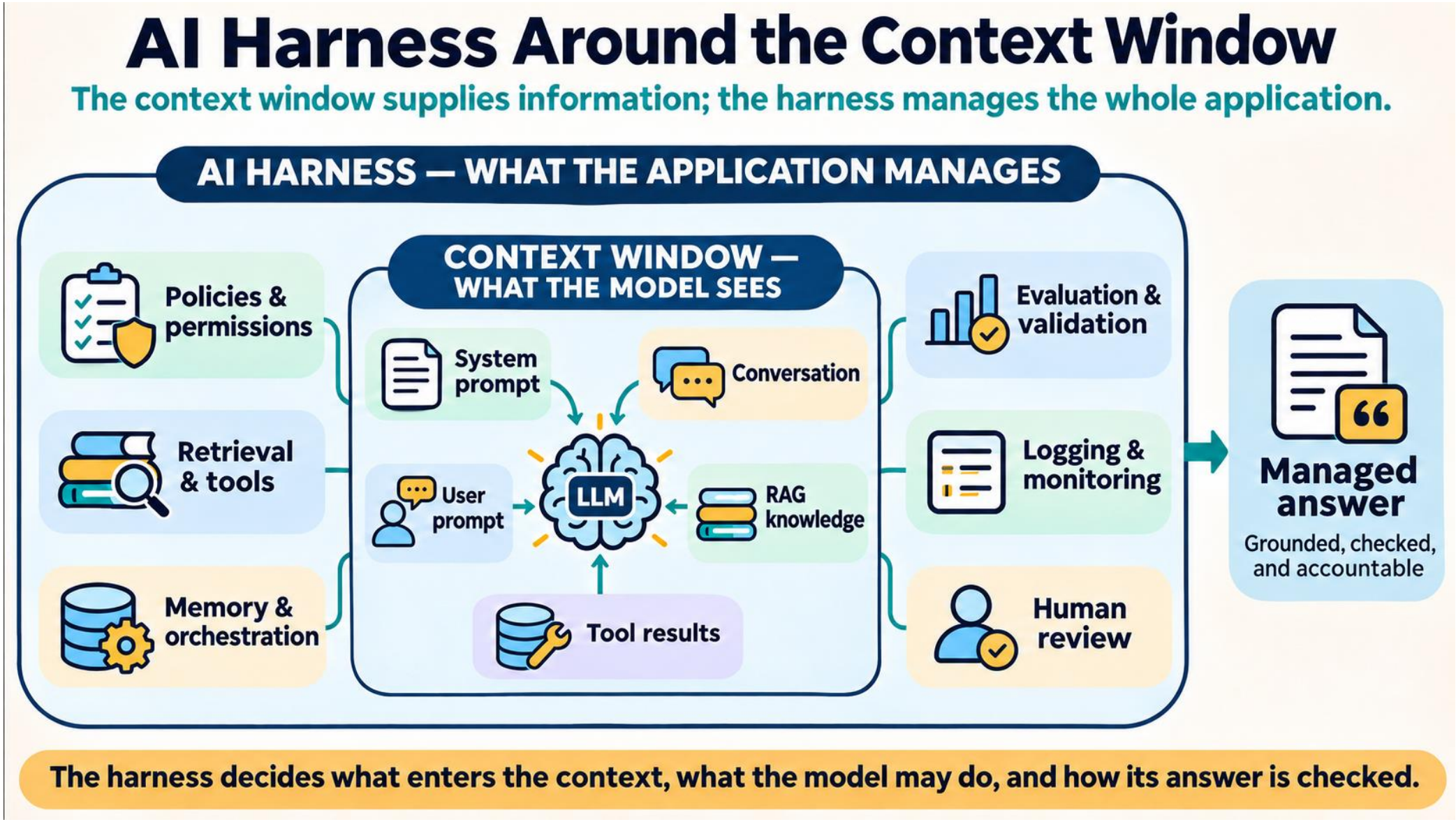
RAG (AI building foundations)



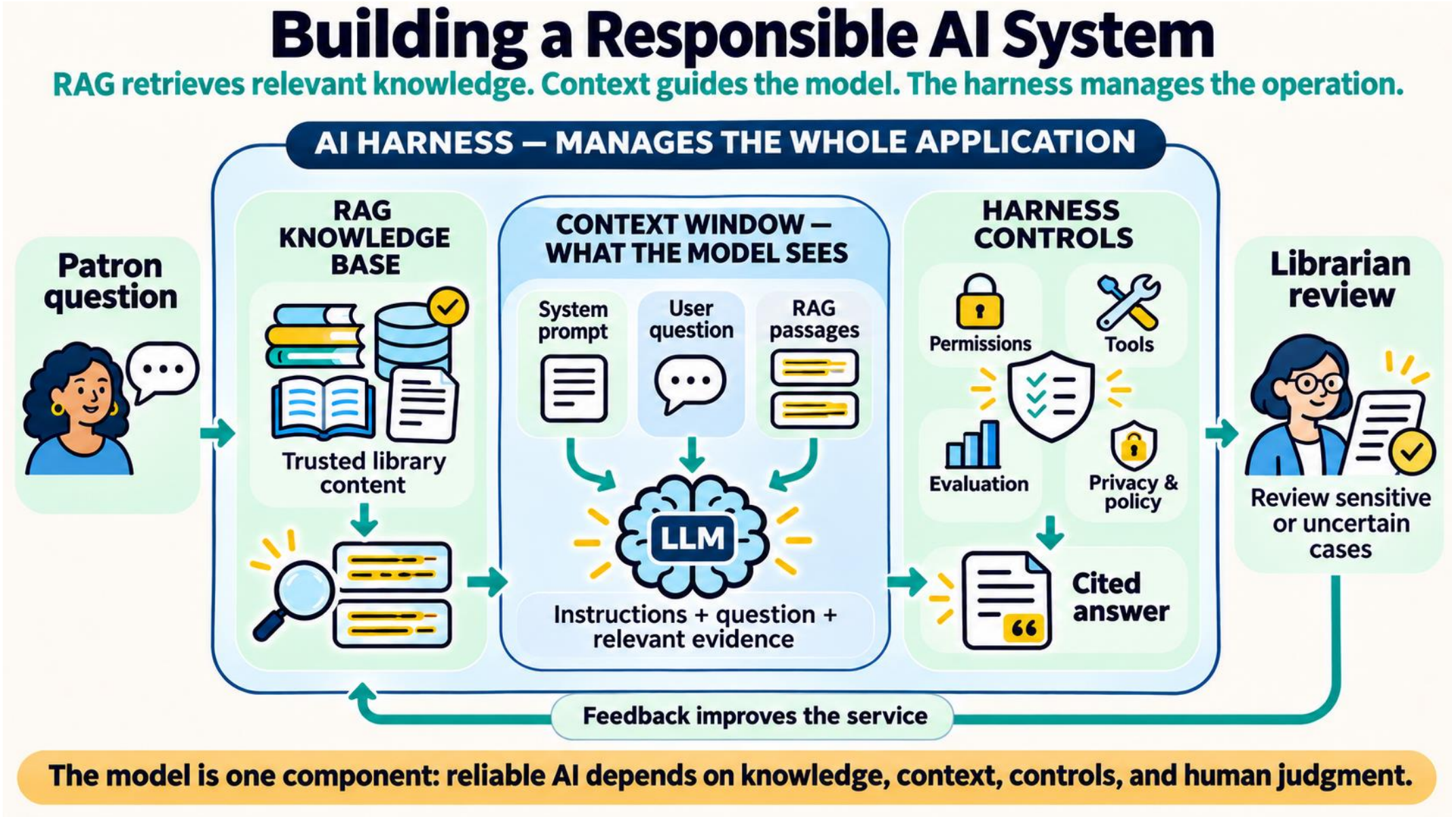
Context Engineering (AI building foundations)



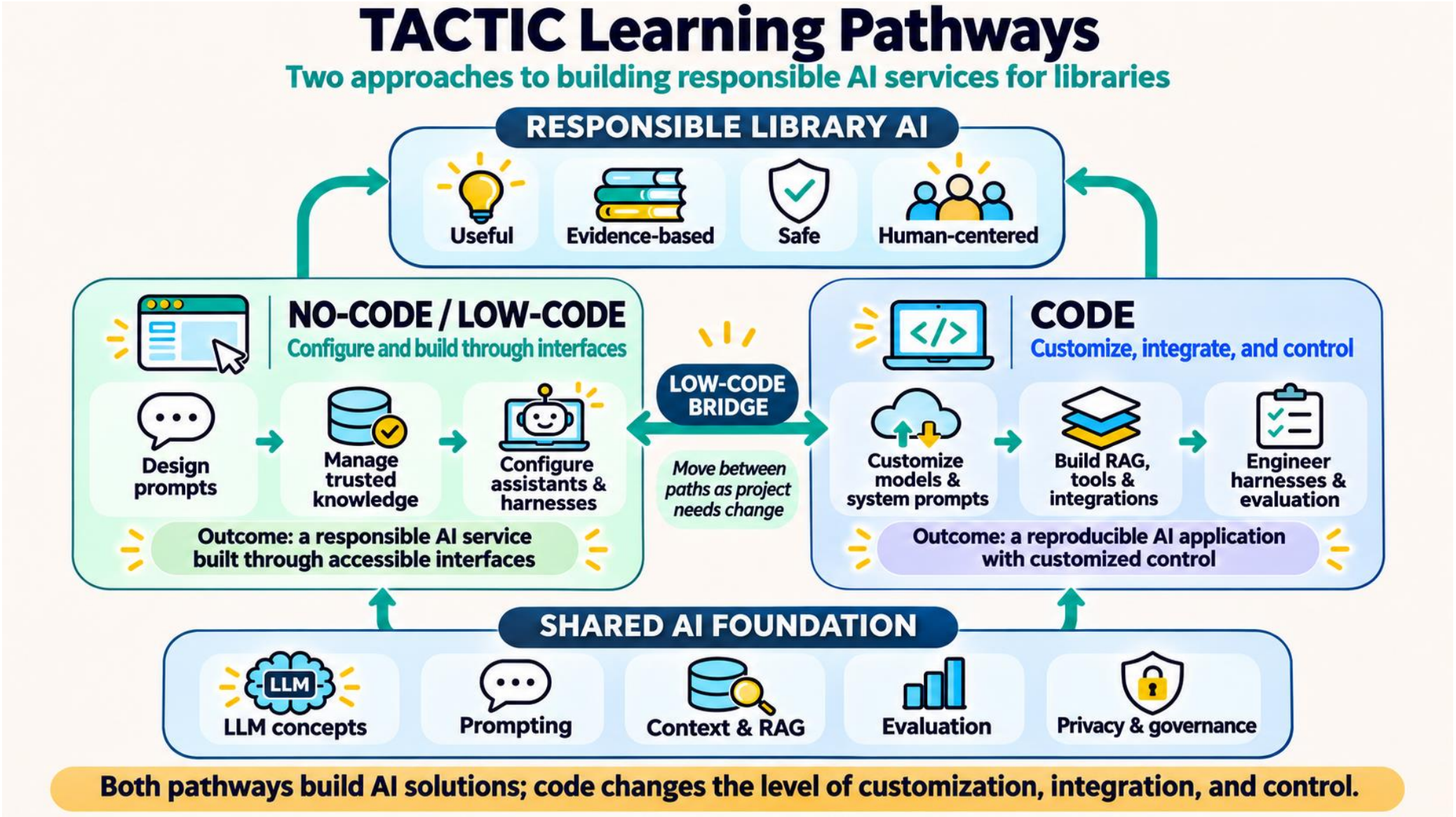
Harness (AI building foundations)



AI System in Libraries



TACTIC in Lib Training



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